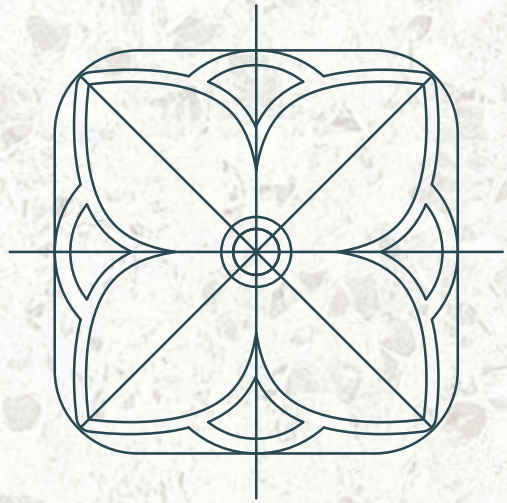




DESIGN COMPETITION ARCHITECTURAL BRIEF

Prepared by RP Infrastructure & ISRA
for Museum of Islamic Art Australia
18 August 2025



ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF COUNTRY

The Museum of Islamic Art Australia (MIAA) respectfully acknowledges the Wangal and Wategora people of the Dharug Nation as the traditional owners of the land where the museum will be located. MIAA acknowledges the local Cumberland Council protocols and processes for engaging First Nations landowners in relation to the future museum construction and subsequent operations. As part of our community-focused efforts MIAA also intends to participate in the care of the natural areas surrounding the museum.

We pay our respects to their Elders past, present and emerging.

Photo by David Clode on Unsplash

Welcome Message

It is with great excitement and purpose that I welcome you to the architectural design brief for the Museum of Islamic Art Australia. As the Executive Director of the Islamic Sciences and Research Academy (ISRA), I am honoured to introduce this visionary project, which will be located in Western Sydney and serve as a cultural landmark for all of Sydney and, indeed, for Australia.

ISRA was founded to promote deeper understanding and engagement with Muslims, their religion, culture and civilisation, through high-quality education, research, and community outreach. Over the years, we have become a bridge between the Islamic tradition and the wider Australian society, offering meaningful insights into the richness, diversity, and relevance of Islamic civilisation.

Our vision is clear and unwavering: to be a leading institution for the advancement of Islamic awareness, spiritual growth, and community wellbeing in Australia.

The Museum of Islamic Art Australia is a natural extension of this vision, a space that celebrates beauty, fosters understanding, and inspires connection. The role of the museum will be multifaceted. It will be a centre for cultural education, a repository for historical and contemporary Islamic art, and a place of encounter where Australians of all backgrounds can explore the artistic and intellectual contributions of Muslims throughout history and today. Through its exhibitions, programs, and design, the museum will tell a story that is both global and local, reflecting the heritage of Islamic art while capturing the Australian Muslim experience.

Our aspirations for the museum are bold and ambitious. We aim to create a space that reflects excellence in architectural design, environmental harmony, and spiritual symbolism. It will be an inclusive, engaging and contemporary institution, accessible to all, deeply rooted in authenticity, and connected to the future. The museum will

be a place of inspiration for young minds, a resource for educators and researchers, and a cultural beacon that contributes to a more cohesive and confident Australian society.

This architectural brief marks the beginning of a transformative journey. We invite you to join us in shaping a museum that not only houses art, but also expresses a vision, of unity in diversity, of beauty in spirit, and of shared humanity in the heart of Western Sydney.

Prof Mehmet Ozalp
Executive Director
ISRA

(Islamic Sciences and Research Academy)



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INVITATION

- 1.1 Purpose
- 1.2 Aim of Competition
- 1.3 The Client
- 1.4 Background to the Project
- 1.5 Mission Statement
- 1.6 Project Budget
- 1.7 Project Program and Staging



Purpose

This document is intended to brief participants on the Architectural Design Competition. It provides the parameters for developing a design solution for the construction of the new Museum of Islamic Art Australia (MIAA) in Granville NSW. The design is expected to meet the requirements of the NSW Government as the funder and Islamic Sciences and Research Academy (ISRA) as the organisation leading the project.

This document, together with its appendices and attachments, describes the functional requirements for development of the MIAA.

The Architectural Design Competition will result in selection of an architect who is best able to work with ISRA, the Client, to enable the vision of establishing a museum to showcase and develop local Islamic art and artists in Australia.

This Competition invites architectural proposals that are ambitious, visionary and thoughtfully designed balancing aesthetic excellence, functionality, sustainability and sensitivity to the project's context. The winning design should align with the Competition brief while demonstrating intelligent use of resources within the given budget.

The project aspires to create an iconic, world-class institution that fosters education, dialogue and appreciation of Islamic artistic traditions.

The new museum will include permanent and temporary gallery spaces, a theatrette, art workshop and learning spaces, multipurpose function rooms, a café, a gift shop and administration spaces.

Architects are invited to present innovative and culturally resonant concepts that seamlessly integrate form, function and symbolism, offering an immersive experience for visitors while respecting the principles of Islamic aesthetics and sustainable design.

Aim of Competition

The Competition will inspire pioneering and culturally sensitive architectural designs for a new Islamic Arts Museum – a landmark institution that embodies the richness, diversity and depth of Islamic art and culture. This museum will serve as a dynamic hub for exhibition, education and research while fostering cross-cultural dialogue and meaningful community engagement.

Through this competition, ISRA aims to:

- Transform a former car yard into a green, climate-positive cultural asset, creating a sustainable museum that enhances the site's ecological and cultural significance.
- Establish a collaborative cultural destination that invites public interaction, offering immersive experiences that inspire learning, creativity and appreciation of Islamic arts.
- Revitalise a commercial space, transforming it into a vibrant and meaningful place that contributes to the community's social and cultural fabric.

This competition is an opportunity to redefine contemporary museum architecture by embracing sustainability, inclusivity, and artistic innovation while honouring the timeless traditions of Islamic art.

A monochromatic, teal-toned photograph of a book fair or library event. In the foreground, a woman with long dark hair and glasses is looking down at a book. Next to her, a woman wearing a hijab and glasses is also looking at a book. In the background, other people are visible, including a man with a beard looking towards the camera. The overall atmosphere is one of quiet activity and learning.

The Client

The Client for this project is ISRA, which was established in 2009. ISRA is a non-profit community organisation that emphasises community service, education and research. ISRA provides a unique approach and focus on community service and development in religious, intellectual, artistic, social, environmental and other major areas for Australia and the global society. It is also a platform for cooperation between Australian Muslims, educational, religious and cultural institutions in Australia.

ISRA has a partnership agreement with Charles Sturt University (CSU) to jointly provide Islamic studies and Arabic courses. The Centre for Islamic Studies and Civilisation within CSU was established in 2011 and the first tertiary courses in Islamic studies began to be offered. The accredited Islamic studies courses at undergraduate and postgraduate levels have been developed with the advice and assistance of ISRA's advisory committee, which includes some of the most respected Muslim scholars from the wider Australian Muslim community.

ISRA runs an extensive Community Engagement Program, which expanded in 2020 to include art and literature. Through its initiative to establish the MIAA, ISRA is making significant investments to grow its presence in the art space. It will address the lack of representation and engagement in this important area for the Australian Muslim community.

ISRA has dedicated centres in Sydney and Melbourne, and its services are provided throughout Australia and online.



Background to the Project

The MIAA is a groundbreaking community-led initiative with the vision of establishing a dedicated museum to showcase and nurture local Islamic art and artists in Australia. Spearheaded by ISRA and supported by its diverse partners, the project gained significant momentum in 2022 when ISRA presented an ambitious proposal for a world-class museum to the NSW government. This proposal was met with strong support, culminating in successful acquisition of a generous grant (\$26.3m) through the WestInvest Community Project Grants initiative, a NSW State Government program aimed at funding transformative projects across Western Sydney, where the museum will be proudly located.

The journey to establish MIAA began with the submission of the WestInvest Program application on 30 July 2022. Following a rigorous evaluation process, ISRA received confirmation of its successful grant application on 19 January 2023, marking a pivotal milestone for the project. By 1 August 2023, the museum's location was confirmed to shift from Blacktown to the Cumberland or Parramatta Local Government Area (LGA), aligning with the vision of creating a museum in Western Sydney. The formal signing of the funding deed with the NSW government on 30 November 2023 solidified the financial foundation for the museum's development.

In early 2024, ISRA's Board made the strategic decision to pursue the Oriole Park Auburn site as the museum's home, formally submitting an Expression of Interest to Cumberland Council on 22 June 2024. This decision was followed by extensive community consultations, beginning with a national meeting on 15 July 2024, which brought together ISRA's board, staff, members and volunteers to ensure the project reflected the aspirations of the community it serves.

Key appointments further advanced the project, including engagement of RP Infrastructure as the project manager for museum construction on 25 July 2024 and the appointment of Nur Shkempi as Artistic Director and Curator on 28 July 2024. These steps underscored the MIAA's commitment to excellence in infrastructure and artistic vision.

On 1 October 2024, the initiative underwent a significant transformation, adopting the name "Museum of Islamic Art Australia" following an extensive consultation process. This change reflected the museum's broader mission to celebrate Islamic art and culture on a national scale.

The project reached another critical milestone in July 2025, when ISRA acquired

the site at 99 Parramatta Road, Granville, securing a new home for the museum following the unsuccessful attempt to lease the Oriole Park site on Tavistock Street, Auburn.

Since securing the WestInvest grant, the MIAA has commenced phase one of its operations, focusing on preparatory work for the museum's building and design, as well as delivering satellite events and partnerships aimed at fostering arts engagement and community involvement. These efforts highlight the MIAA's commitment to becoming a dynamic cultural institution that not only preserves and promotes Islamic art but also strengthens social cohesion and enriches Australia's cultural landscape.

Mission Statement

The MIAA's mission statement highlights its three key functions and overarching aspiration.

The MIAA promotes deeper understanding and appreciation of Islamic art, culture and civilisation within Australian society and globally. As a community-led initiative, the MIAA is committed to creating a platform that highlights and supports local Islamic art and artists. Through this effort, the museum will contribute to the development of a distinct Australian Muslim identity, expressed creatively through art and literature.



Photo by Kareem Saleh on Unsplash

Project Budget

The total project funding is \$26.3m. This includes allowances for land acquisition, construction, project management, consultants, authority fees, furniture, fixtures and equipment, gallery installations and contingencies.

The construction phase budget is \$14.25m, which covers demolition of the existing structure, site remediation, construction of the new museum, associated external and landscaping works, and the structural reinforcement necessary to enable future vertical expansion of the building.

This project has been approved for grant funding; therefore, specific requirements will need to be satisfied. Refer to the Funding Deed requirements provided at Appendix A.

Project Program and Staging

A three-year program is anticipated for the design and construction of the MIAA. The master program is provided at Appendix B.

The architectural design will be reconciled against the functional brief, and a full consultant team will be appointed for the schematic design in December 2025. The Detailed Design and submission of the Development Application is targeted for mid-2026.

Following preparation of the complete detailed design pack, construction works will run for approximately 17 months with the MIAA opening in March 2029.



JURY

2.1 The Jury

The Three Sisters Rock Formation

MIAA Architecture Design Competition

Page 11

The Jury



Prof Mehmet Ozalp

Prof Mehmet Ozalp is an award-winning professor of Islamic studies, public intellectual and most-respected community leader with three decades of community service. He is the founder and Head of School for the Centre for Islamic Studies and Civilisation (CISAC) at Charles Sturt University. In 2009, Mehmet founded ISRA, Islamic Sciences and Research Academy and is the serving Executive Director. Mehmet is the founder and editor-in-chief of the Australian Journal of Islamic Studies. Mehmet is the author of more than 50 publications including six books. Mehmet was awarded Australian Bluestar Award in Education (2011) and Charles Sturt University Professional Excellence Award (2012), Australian Muslim Role Model of the Year award (2012), Australian Muslim Lifetime Achievement Award (2018) and CSU Teaching Scholar of the Year (2023).



Orhan Kaba

Orhan Kaba is an Accredited Building Designer with over 40 years of industry experience and a Full Member of the Building Designers Association of Australia. As Managing Director and Proprietor of Designiche P/L Building Designers, he has built a respected practice known for excellence in residential design. Orhan specializes in custom homes, duplexes, multi-residential developments, and has also designed award-winning display homes for leading Sydney builders as well as childcare centres and community-focused developments. Designiche was also chosen as the Design Review Panel to oversee and approve all applications within The Shearwater Estate in Warriewood and the Iluka Estate in Little Bay, contributing to the thoughtful shaping of these estates. Designiche's clientele includes home builders, property developers, and individual clients seeking to build their dream home. Orhan's commitment to innovative, practical, and sustainable design continues to position him as a trusted and sought after practitioner in the Greater Sydney region.



Dr Nur Shkembi OAM

Dr Nur Shkembi is an award-winning curator, writer and art historian with a research specialisation in Islamic art history, contemporary art and postcolonial theory. Nur has produced and curated over 150 events, exhibitions and community engagement projects and was part of the core team which established the Islamic Museum of Australia, serving as the museum's inaugural Art Director, Exhibitions Manager and foundation Curator. Nur has served on numerous boards and committees, including the Museums, Cultural Heritage and Cultural Development Advisory committee and the Organisation Investment Program. In 2018, she was appointed by the Department of Premier and Cabinet as a Commissioner for the Creative State Commissions. Exhibitions include Soul Fury (Bendigo Art Gallery), DOMINION (Arts West Gallery, University of Melbourne) and Destiny Disrupted (Granville Centre Art Gallery and Griffith University Art Museum). Her recent academic publications include "Neo-Orientalism and the Persistence of Holbein Carpets: On Writing the Future History of Islamic Art in Australia" in What is Postnational Art History? (Perimeter Editions) and "Destiny Disrupted: A History of Contemporary Islamic Art in 'Australia'" in Variations (Monash University Press). Nur holds a PhD in Art History from the University of Melbourne, where she is a sessional academic in the Master of Art Curatorship program. Nur is a sessional lecturer in the Master of Arts Management program at RMIT University. In 2024, Nur was appointed as the Artistic Director and Curator of MIAA.

The Jury



Belqis Youssofzay

Belqis Youssofzay is the director of Sydney-based architecture practice Youssofzay Hart. The practice works across a spectrum of project typologies grounded by concerns of civic generosity, accessibility and a sustainable future. Over the past seven years, the practice has built a diverse portfolio of works for some of the most renowned cultural institutions in Australia and globally. In 2022, the practice was part of the winning team for the Powerhouse Ultimo Renewal and continue to participate as the emerging architect in the realisation of the project. In 2024, the practice was commissioned by M+ museum Hong Kong for two large scale installations. Belqis was also the recipient of the 2015 Byera Hadley Travelling Scholarship awarded by the NSW Board of Architects to research 40 global cultural institutions in Japan, Europe and the United States.



Hannah Slater

Hannah Slater is the Director, Design & Delivery, Powerhouse Program. She leads the design and delivery of the Powerhouse Program, ensuring the requirements of the renewal program are met. Hannah was previously the Australasian Arts and Culture Business Lead at Arup, managing the pursuits, coordination and delivery of Arup’s major cultural projects. Prior to that she worked at Infrastructure NSW leading the development and delivery of a number of major projects, including Powerhouse Parramatta and the Blackwattle Bay State Significant Precinct rezoning. Hannah is a registered Architect and Project Manager and brings over 15 years’ experience in the arts and cultural sector nationally and internationally.

Museum of Islamic Art

SCOPE AND OBJECTIVES

3.1 A Showcase for Islamic Art
3.2 Project Scope



A Showcase for Islamic Art

The MIAA is a non-profit organisation that will stand as a unique cultural institution within the City of Parramatta LGA, Sydney, and Australia. It is a community led initiative with the vision of establishing a museum to showcase and develop local Islamic art and artists in Australia. Its vision is to showcase, support and develop local Islamic artists and artforms. The museum aspires to become a premier cultural institution that fosters creativity, dialogue and education.

MIAA is committed to achieving its strategic objectives:

- Present world-class permanent galleries, temporary and visiting exhibitions, and programming which attract tourists and other visitors to Western Sydney.
- Establish and maintain permanent and temporary gallery spaces according to local and international museum standards.
- Establish and maintain facilities within the museum premises as part of the museum Community Access Program.
- Establish and maintain a dynamic cultural facility which serves the community as a venue for a variety of cultural and educational activities.
- Collect, preserve and display art and cultural material that reflects the diverse experiences and expressions of Islamic art and culture both here and abroad.
- Showcase the rich and diverse civilisations and artistic legacy of Islam spanning across history to the contemporary era, fostering appreciation and understanding.
- Cultivate a sense of inclusion and identity for Muslims in Australia by celebrating Islamic art, contributing to the positive development of the Australian Muslim identity.
- Promote community harmony and social cohesion through intercultural dialogue, events and artistic initiatives.
- Collaborate with local and international cultural institutions for the purposes of object/artwork loans, touring exhibitions and advancing research in Islamic art.
- Enhance learning opportunities for school-aged children and adults by curating and presenting content within the galleries which engage the New South Wales and Australian curriculum.

Project Scope

The project involves construction of a museum with a focus on Islamic arts, culture and history to facilitate the artistic and cultural output of the Muslim community in Western Sydney and beyond. The Western Sydney region faces liveability challenges due to limited access to social and cultural infrastructure.

The MIAA will address the cultural, educational and social needs of current and emerging communities within the Parramatta LGA and Greater Sydney. It will promote intercultural understanding and inclusion by providing contemporary facilities for art and community engagement programs.

These programs will offer creative, safe and welcoming spaces, enhancing community participation and fostering community cohesion.

The key benefits the museum will deliver include:

Contribute to art and culture in Sydney

MIAA will make a major contribution to the artistic and cultural landscape in Sydney.

Enhance Western Sydney’s cultural significance

The museum will elevate the local cultural profile, positioning it as a centre for artistic and cultural engagement by attracting visitors from across the Sydney metropolitan region.

Provide a creative hub and artistic link

It will serve as a hub for creative expression, linking Cumberland area to the broader artistic community in Greater Sydney, fostering creativity and collaboration.

Boost local economy

By attracting visitors, the museum will increase foot traffic, thereby boosting the local economy through tourism and related activities. The museum’s unique design and services will make it a landmark attraction, expected to draw over 20,000 school students, teachers, and community members annually.

Enhance social cohesion

The museum will contribute to social cohesion by providing a space where diverse communities can come together to appreciate and engage with Islamic art and culture.

Foster community relationships

The museum will enhance community relations, promoting inclusiveness and connectedness. This will build bridges of dialogue and inclusion, showcasing the religious diversity of local communities and serving the broader needs of diverse communities in Cumberland and Greater Sydney.

Host large-scale projects

The venue will host ISRA’s large-scale projects such as the highly successful Sydney Muslim Writers Festival and Risala Festival, which are normally held at other LGAs, furthering educational and cultural initiatives.

Provide a versatile event space

The event spaces will be available to other organisations and community groups to hire for events and programs, maximising its use and benefits to the community.

Provide casual and formal function areas

The venue will include a café and function room, which will provide an inspiring space for the community. The café and function room will activate the site beyond museum operating times to bring community and income to the museum.



THE SITE

- 4.1 Competition Site
- 4.2 Future Potential for Expansion
- 4.3 Heritage Context, Archaeology & Planning Framework

Photo by Vincent Yuan
on Unsplash

Competition Site

The site is at 99 Parramatta Road, Granville (Lot 1 DP 532209), within the Parramatta City Council LGA. Situated in the suburb of Granville in Western Sydney, the site is an irregular shaped allotment of approximately 1,789m² with wide frontage to Parramatta Road and bound by Carlotta Lane and Harmon Lane to the northern and eastern boundaries, respectively. It is approximately 400 metres from Granville train station, providing strong public transport connectivity.

The immediate surrounds reflect a transitional urban character. Car dealerships adjoin the site to the east, west and south. The land immediately to the north, across Carlotta Lane, is zoned R3 residential before transitioning to R2 residential. Parramatta Road to the south is lined with a mix of commercial and light industrial uses. The site previously operated as a car dealership and sits at the interface of residential, commercial and industrial zones, making it a strategic position for the museum and its future development opportunities.

See Appendix C for site photographs.



Opportunities for Design:

- Public engagement spaces: Consider how the design can use the main road frontage and proximity to Granville Station for community events/café, activating the site and engaging visitors beyond the museum's main operations.
- Architectural statement: The site's wide frontage and high visibility offers the opportunity to provide a striking architectural statement and iconic building for high public exposure along the busy Parramatta Road.
- Vehicular access and parking: Basement carpark will be required for museum usages. Adequate space for car and bus parking, loading dock movements, general deliveries and rubbish removal should be incorporated into the design. Design solutions might include suitable on-site parking and end of trip facilities to minimise the impact on the surrounding area and use the location's proximity to Granville Station.
- Flexible floorplate: Level 1 is intended to have a flexible floorplate that accommodates open plan office spaces, function room, multipurpose rooms and indoor and outdoor connections.

Future Potential for Expansion

The design should consider future opportunities to maximise the site's development potential. Several factors present possibilities for expanding the museum in the future:

- The site's zoning permits a multi-storey building beyond what is proposed in the initial stage.
- The opening of the new Powerhouse Museum in Parramatta will strengthen the area's role as a cultural hub, increasing visitor numbers and creating demand for new galleries and exhibitions.
- The museum's anticipated success as a unique cultural institution may necessitate additional facilities and expansion.
- Proximity to the train station positions the site in a growth area, creating potential demand for expanding the museum and increasing community engagement.
- The area's growing number of high-rise residential buildings is likely to increase the need for community facilities and services.

Accordingly, the design should incorporate provisions for additional levels to the building in the future. How these outcomes can be achieved – considering local government parking requirements and constraints of the existing structure – should be explored.

Further discussion on this is provided in section 5 of this document.

Heritage Context, Archaeology & Planning Framework

The site is zoned E3 Productivity Support under the Parramatta Local Environmental Plan 2023, which allows for mixed-use development subject to consent. It also falls within the Granville Precinct of the Parramatta Road Corridor Urban Transformation Strategy, which promotes increased density, commercial activity and revitalisation of underutilised urban land.

Architects should investigate current planning controls and permissible uses and obtain town planning advice to ensure a compliant proposal.

Heritage

There is no known heritage significance to the site or the current existing buildings on the site. Architect to undertake further investigations during the competition period.

Archaeology

The site is disturbed; therefore, it is unlikely that any significant Indigenous or European archaeological potential remains.

DESIGN BRIEF

- 5.1 Design Aspirations
- 5.2 Aesthetics and Design Principles
- 5.3 Staged Design and Construction
- 5.4 Specific Operational Considerations
- 5.5 Commercial Vision
- 5.6 Functional Requirements
- 5.7 Functional Area Specifications

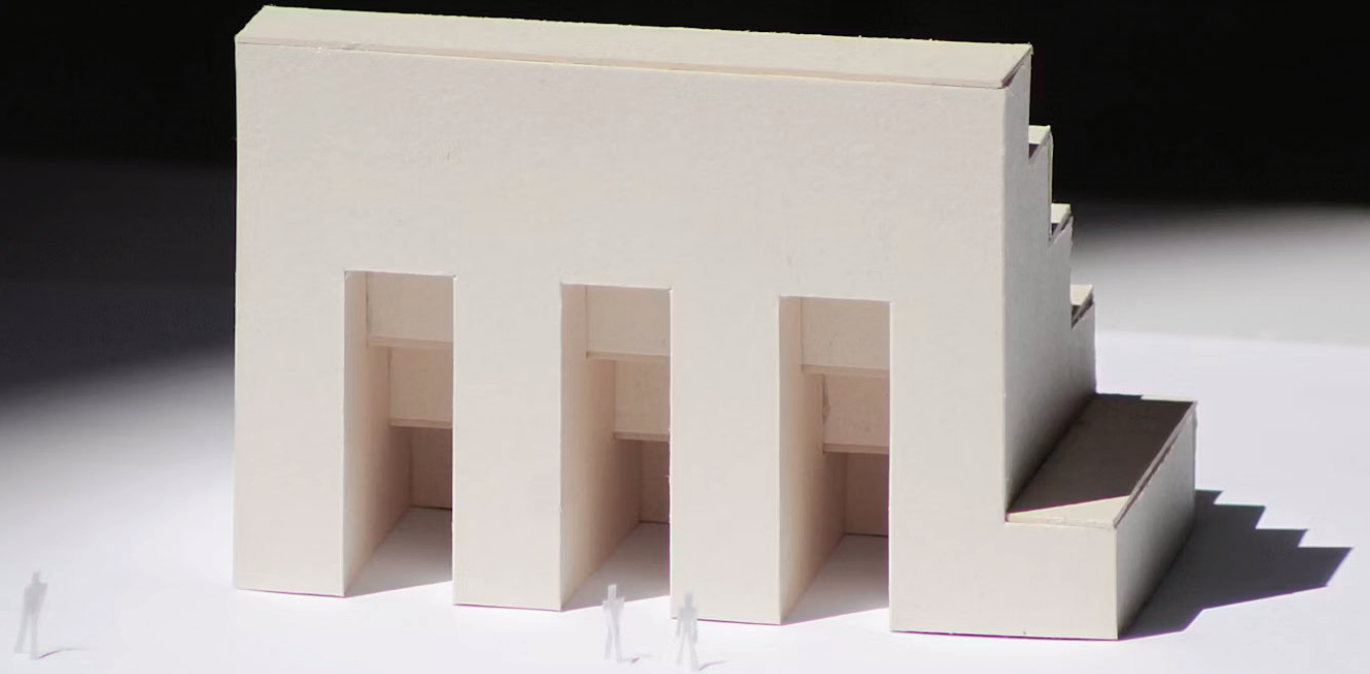


Photo by Fernando Andrade
on Unsplash

Design Aspirations

» A Fusion of Traditional and Contemporary Architecture

Incorporate Islamic aesthetics and design principles into a contemporary building that reflects the rich artistic heritage of the Muslim world fused with modern technology and architectural expressions to create a contemporary building.

» A Cultural Landmark

Design a visually striking, iconic building that becomes a work of art in itself and a source of pride for both Muslim Australians and the broader public.

» Spiritual Tranquillity in Space

Create serene and reflective spaces that embody the spiritual dimensions of Islamic art and invite cognitive and emotional contemplation.

» A Multisensory, Immersive Experience

Design museum galleries’ multi-sensory engagement through the innovative use of artefacts, light, technology and sound.

» Flexible Exhibition Spaces

Ensure adaptable gallery spaces that can accommodate both permanent and temporary exhibitions and allow cost-effective reconfiguration.

» Enhanced Visitor Circulation and Experience

Design a prominent sense of arrival at entrance and clear internal circulation paths that create a transformative pedagogical journey through galleries and communal spaces.

» Creative and Social Learning Hubs

Integrate learning opportunities within art display areas, study rooms, and community event spaces to foster creativity and connection.

» Commercial and Experiential Synergy

Design spaces that generate commercial revenue to support operations while enhancing the overall visitor experience.

» Operational Efficiency and Growth

Ensure functional efficiency across all operational areas, with built-in flexibility to support the museum’s long-term growth and expansion.

The museum branding contract was awarded to the winning designer, Aliyah Quadan, owner and principle designer of Mochi Creative. The branding colour scheme and icons will appear in the interior and exterior of the museum, specifically permanent and temporary signage and displays, and advertising. The overall design and branding will help communicate our museum to the world.

Note: The colour scheme is only one of multiple possible palettes. We encourage Competition teams to use the current palette or offer their own.

Please refer to Appendix D for the current museum branding and logo design.

Aesthetics and Design Principles

The building should be a work of art. The architectural design of the museum and surrounds will form part of the story and learning experience for visitors. In other words, the building design will reflect and acknowledge the significance of architecture in the Islamic arts. By incorporating Islamic aesthetics and design principles, it is intended that the museum structure be an example of architecture that will be studied and form part of the museum 'art'.

For further detail, refer to Appendix F.

Collections

MIAA currently holds no formal or informal collection. The galleries will be curated with a selection of artworks that will be purposefully acquired, donated or commissioned over the course of the building process.

Long and short-term loans and technology will complete the displays, whilst the museum itself, a work of Islamic art, reflects the local environment, the Australian Muslim history and stories.

See Appendix E for gallery content (indicative only).

Staged Design and Construction

Staging Rationale

There are several reasons why the museum’s design and construction should be staged:

- As outlined in Section 4.2, the site has significant potential for future expansion, which must be factored into the building’s design and construction from the outset.
- The current budget, set in 2022, is now constrained due to delays in land acquisition and rising construction costs.
- The design should reflect the museum’s long-term vision rather than being limited to the immediate requirements for its initial opening.
- Staging allows the museum to adapt its design and facilities in response to emerging trends in museum engagement, visitor expectations and technological innovation, rather than locking into a fixed concept.

A staged approach will ensure the museum can open in a financially viable form while retaining the flexibility to expand in line with strategic growth, funding opportunities and evolving community engagement needs.

Three-Stage Construction Requirement

The museum will be designed as a three-stage development, with all stages fully developed in the architectural plans from the outset.

- Stage 1 will be the minimum build necessary to commence operations as a viable museum.
- Stage 2 will be constructed concurrently with Stage 1 if budget permits and/or additional funding is secured. If this is not financially feasible, strategies for delivering Stage 2 at a later date should be developed and incorporated into the plan.
- Stage 3 will be delivered at a future date as funding and operational needs dictate.

Only stages 1 and 2 will be included in the initial Development Application.

Stage 1 – Initial Construction (Grand Opening 2029)

Stage 1 is envisaged as the initial construction phase, completed and operational in time for the grand opening in 2029. It will deliver the minimum rooms, spaces and specifications required to operate the museum, along with essential ancillary facilities needed to support its functions.

Stage 1 inclusions:

- Parking to meet City of Parramatta requirements
- Entry and front-of-house facilities
- Museum galleries (excluding the fit-out for the Immersive Gallery and Sacred Spaces Exhibition Gallery)
- Collection storage room
- Loading dock
- Café and kitchen
- Function room
- Production room
- Four offices
- Meeting room
- Staff and student/visitor breakout area
- Gift shop
- Amenities, including ablution facilities
- Consideration for integrating solar panels and main power

Stage 1 will provide a fully functional museum that can operate as a viable cultural institution from day one, while also being designed to integrate seamlessly with stages 2 and 3 expansions.

Stage 2 – Deferred Construction or Fit-Out

Stage 2 comprises rooms and spaces that are integral to the museum’s medium-term operation but may be constructed or fitted out at a later date, depending on the availability of funds. While deferred, these components should be fully integrated into the architectural design to ensure they can be delivered without disruption.

- The architect should explore strategies to maximise Stage 2 delivery within the initial construction phase, ideally completing stages 1 and 2 in time for the grand opening in 2029.
- Items in Stage 2 may be advanced into Stage 1 if the budget allows.
- All or part of Stage 2 may be built to a simple shell during Stage 1, with internal fit-out completed when funding is secured.

If Stage 2 cannot be incorporated into Stage 1 construction:

- Provision must be made in Stage 1 for the future functionality and buildability of these spaces as retrofit projects.
- Stage 2 works should be included in the Development Application as part of staged consent to secure council approval in advance.

Stage 2 inclusions:

- Immersive Gallery – complete fit-out
- Faith Exhibition Gallery– complete fit-out
- Theatrette – complete fit-out
- Two art/learning spaces
- Additional storage
- Archive storage
- Additional amenities as required

Stage 2 ensures the museum can scale its facilities and services to meet its full planned capacity while maintaining design coherence, operational efficiency and long-term sustainability.

Stage 3 – Future Development

Stage 3 is a forward-planning consideration intended to fully realise the site’s development potential. The site’s current planning controls allow for a floor space ratio (FSR) of 3:1 and a height limit of 21 metres; however, a recent DA approval for the site permitted a building height of 30 metres.

The proposed museum in stages 1 and 2 will have an approximate total floor area of 2,300m², leaving around 3,000 m² of unrealised allowable floor space under the current FSR. The E3 zoning permits a range of potential future development opportunities that could be explored in this stage. The architect should investigate options for incorporating additional floors into the long-term masterplan, ensuring the building can accommodate vertical expansion as required.

Key Stage 3 planning considerations:

- Parking provision: Strategies for accommodating additional parking requirements beyond stages 1 and 2, including potential reconfiguration or expansion of existing parking facilities.
- Structural capacity: Designing stages 1 and 2 with sufficient structural integrity to support additional levels in the future.
- Access: Providing for alternative and multiple access points to additional floors, ensuring visitor flow, safety and compliance with building codes. For example, stairwells, elevators, emergency exits and service access.

Building Form Considerations

The architect should determine the optimum building form in light of budget constraints and long-term functional needs. This should include evaluating whether:

- The building should be elevated above at-grade parking, or
- Parking should be accommodated in an excavated basement if required.

These options should be assessed for their impact on budget, visual street appeal, aesthetic quality, operational functionality and integration with future expansion stages.

For further detail please refer to Appendix F.

Specific Operational Considerations

Entry and Front-of-House

In Islamic architecture, the entry often serves as a major focal point, with grand foyers that also function as versatile event spaces. For the museum, this entry area will be a free, non-ticketed zone, enabling guests and casual visitors to access the gift shop and café without paying the museum entry fee.

The function room should be located on this entry level, with the ability to expand into the foyer space to accommodate larger events. To maximise efficiency and reduce costs, the function room should have access to the café kitchen for catering needs.

At minimum, the entry level should include the foyer, café with kitchen, function room, gift shop and visitor reception.

Multimedia and Immersive Technology Gallery

This gallery will showcase Islamic art, history and culture through cutting-edge digital and interactive technologies. It will be designed as a flexible, darkened environment capable of delivering high-quality visual, auditory and sensory experiences that complement the museum's physical collections.

The purpose is to create a dynamic, technology-rich gallery that broadens audience engagement, especially among

younger and tech-savvy visitors, while offering new ways to interpret and experience Islamic art, history and cultural narratives.

The Multimedia and Immersive Technology Gallery will combine a range of interactive and sensory technologies to create an engaging visitor experience. Through virtual reality, visitors can explore reconstructed historical sites, architectural masterpieces and cultural landscapes in a fully immersive format. Augmented and mixed reality will overlay digital information and visualisations onto real-world exhibits, deepening the interpretation of artefacts and themes. Large-format projections and LED displays, including high-resolution projection mapping and panoramic screens, will transform the space into enveloping visual environments, enhanced by spatial audio and soundscapes that deliver realistic and atmospheric effects.

Visitors will be able to interact directly with exhibits via touchscreens and motion sensors, allowing them to navigate, manipulate and explore digital content. The gallery will be designed with a flexible layout, enabling it to adapt to a wide variety of exhibition themes, from fully immersive cinematic shows to smaller, interactive learning modules.

Design considerations:

- Controlled lighting and acoustic isolation from other galleries to maximise immersion.
- Robust digital infrastructure, including high-capacity data cabling, network connections and AV equipment housing.
- Climate and environmental controls consistent with museum standards for visitor comfort and technology reliability.
- Accessibility for all visitors, ensuring inclusive experiences for diverse age groups and abilities.

Faith Exhibition Gallery

The Faith Exhibition Gallery will be an immersive exhibition space designed to accommodate large groups and form an essential part of the museum's visitor experience. Rather than functioning as a traditional gallery of displayed objects, it will be a feature, presenting classic Islamic decorative arts—such as tiles, intricate wood carvings, mashrabiya screens and integrated display niches—within a to-scale representation of a mosque interior. This interpretive setting will allow visitors to experience the aesthetic and artistic qualities of mosque design in an educational and cultural context.

To maximise efficiency and reduce costs, the space will be adaptable for use as a prayer area during functions and special events, removing the need for a separate large prayer facility for staff and visitors on those occasions. Design provisions will ensure practical functionality, including areas for shoe removal before entry and retrieval on exit, to maintain visitor flow through the museum.

The gallery should span two floors, creating a generous vertical volume that allows for the integration of intricate ceiling features, architectural detailing and large-scale artworks, enhancing its visual impact and cultural authenticity. The additional height will not only provide an aesthetic focal point but also deliver an immersive visitor experience, echoing the architectural traditions of grand Islamic interiors.

A small mezzanine, accessed from the upper floor, should be incorporated to serve as a discreet private prayer space for staff. This elevated area will be visually separated from the main gallery below by decorative mashrabiya screens, providing privacy and cultural authenticity. Positioned to maintain seclusion while allowing light and air to pass through, the mezzanine will make efficient use of the vertical space without disrupting the interpretive and exhibition functions of the main gallery.

Commercial Vision

ISRA envisions several sustainable income streams within the museum. These include the museum gift shop, café restaurant and world class for-hire facilities such as the function room, theatrette, classrooms and studios. These facilities will not only generate income for the museum operation but also provide a variety of unique spaces for community gatherings and private functions.

To support fair usage and accessibility of the space, ISRA will offer a Community Access Program providing discounted access for not-for-profit organisations and small community-based groups to the museum facilities for workshops, events, special interest groups and clubs, meetings and gatherings.

Architectural considerations include zoned areas for afterhours access, serviceability, functionality and wear. These spaces will also be utilised by the museum to host public programs, community engagement activities and other museum related events and gatherings designed to engage local communities and visitors as part of the fee-paying programming.

- › **Theatrette:** available for commercial hire and via the Community Access Program. The theatrette offers seating, projector, large projector screen, lectern and small stage for lectures, panel discussions and community events.
- › **Learning spaces:** available for commercial hire and via the Community Access Program (CAP). The learning spaces offer a unique opportunity for organisations and groups to host day-long meetings and planning days and other such gatherings.
- › **Function room:** available for commercial hire and via the Community Access Program (CAP). A dedicated space that allows members of the public, community groups and other visitors of the museum to gather for special events, dinners and conferences.
- › **Café and restaurant:** ISRA envisions leasing the café and restaurant to an external operator generating rental income for the museum. The café and restaurant operator will work closely with the museum to design an appropriate menu.
- › **Gift shop:** not available for commercial hire. The giftshop will be owned and operated by the museum. However, it will allow product placement and consignments of artisanal products and giftware appropriate to the museum.
- › **Venue hire:** available for commercial hire and via the Community Access Program. The venue will be available for events and gatherings, as well as offering hire options for onsite photography or filming.
- › **Temporary and permanent galleries:** not available for commercial hire.

Functional Requirements

The design should accommodate up to 2,200m² of internal space for the museum, including 30% allocated for circulation. The table below provides a summary of the areas, their sizes and intended uses.

Further details of the intended museum content (indicative only) are provided in Appendix

1	Gallery 1 (Children’s Gallery and Library)	80 sqm	A dedicated children’s gallery specially curated for safe, hands-on learning and interactivity with art and other curated activities relevant to pre-school and primary school aged children and families. Integrated within the gallery is a dedicated children’s library, offering a curated collection of picture books, educational resources and quiet reading nooks. The library fosters early literacy and imagination, complementing the gallery’s themes and offering a calm retreat for reflection and discovery. Further details of the intended museum content (indicative only) are provided in Appendix E.
2	Gallery 2	80 sqm	A permanent display area for traditional and contemporary Islamic art (curated to national and international standards) for visitor engagement, museum-based education, learning and engagement – open to all ages. This gallery will present specialised content specific to sharing the unique history of Australian-Muslim migration and settlement in Australia with a focus on Western Sydney.
3	Gallery 3	90 sqm	A permanent display of traditional and contemporary Islamic art curated to national and international standards for visitor engagement and museum-based education, learning and engagement – open to all ages.
4	Gallery 4 (Temporary Exhibitions)	180 sqm	A gallery space to receive temporary touring exhibitions and present the museum’s annual curated exhibition program.
5	Gallery 5 (Multimedia & Immersive Technology)	80 sqm	A flexible, technology-rich gallery featuring virtual reality, augmented reality, large-scale projections, spatial audio and interactive digital displays, designed to deliver fully immersive cultural and educational experiences adaptable to a variety of exhibition themes.
6	Sacred Spaces Exhibition Gallery	100 sqm	An immersive space featuring a traditional Islamic interior design. It is intended to be a feature that contains traditional Islamic tiles, arabesque motifs, calligraphy and decorations displayed in harmony in a single space to create an immersive cultural experience.
7	Foyer & Entry	120 sqm	A safe, open and welcoming entry space that visitors, visitor groups, school groups and the community can use as an initial gathering place for tours and other museum functions.
8	Lift Lobby	TBC	Lift lobby to connect all floors and allow for potential additional floors to be added.
9	Gift Shop	50 sqm	A standard museum style gift shop offering a modest selection of museum branded products, locally hand-crafted products and traditional and unique wares.
10	Function Room	120 sqm	A dedicated space that allows members of the public, community groups and other museum visitors to gather for special events – this is a necessary gathering space separate from the galleries where food and drinks can be safely consumed and enjoyed away from artworks and displays (as per museum standard practice). This room should connect to foyer to provide a larger space for bigger events and functions. It should be able to function separately from and while the museum is operating. Acoustic spillage from one function to another as well as from Parramatta Rd should be considered. It will be available for limited community hire through the MIAA Community Access Plan to encourage community connection and engagement with the museum.

11	Cafe & Kitchen	70 sqm	Standard museum café serving light refreshments and meals to visitors and school groups. The café will also service museum visitors, casual passers-by, local workers and community members. The museum envisages the café as a welcoming space for all community members to access and enjoy without requiring paid museum entry.
12	Theatrette	170 sqm	The theatrette offers a dedicated seated space with a projector and lectern for panel discussions, guest lectures (e.g. speciality lectures by art historians and artist talks) and other presentations.
13	Wet & Dry Craft and Learning Spaces 1 and 2	80 sqm	As per standard museum operations, a wet and dry craft room must be available for student groups and other visitors to use for various modes of learning, including hands-on, crafting, art workshops and other learning. These rooms should be designed as general learning spaces to allow regular educational activities.
14	Production Room	25 sqm	A dedicated creative media space for museum staff and for community access (CAP) for small groups or individuals to create podcasts, short videos, interviews and other creative media pursuits.
15	Offices 1 & 2	30 sqm	Two private offices (15m2 each) for managers.
16	Offices 3 & 4	100 sqm	Two open plan office space (50m2 each) for museum staff.
17	Meeting Room	35 sqm	General meeting rooms for staff collaborations and other meetings.
18	Staff and Student Breakout Area	40 sqm	A breakout area for museum staff and students, which will also function as a lunch space. The area should include a small kitchenette to support daily use.
19	Loading Dock	30 sqm	As per standard museum requirements.
20	Storage Rooms	100 sqm	Dedicated storage areas, in line with standard museum requirements, for the café, ground floor operations, first floor operations, gift shop, children's gallery and function room (including tables and chairs).
21	Collection Storage & Conservation	30 sqm	As per standard museum requirements.
22	Archive Room	50 sqm	As per standard museum requirements.
23	Amenities	70 sqm	Self-descriptive and to standard.
24	Plant Rooms	TBC	Self-descriptive and to standard.
25	Parking	TBC	Self-descriptive and to Parramatta Council standards.

Functional Area Specifications

For further details related to museum content intended for each of the galleries, see Appendix E.

Gallery 1 Children & Library

Gallery 1 will be dedicated to children’s displays and activities. Ages will be for preschool and primary school aged children. Soft furnishings and rugs will provide for readings and activities that might occur in the space. There will be an integrated dedicated children’s library within the gallery offering a curated collection of picture books, educational resources and quiet reading nooks. This gallery should be contained and not directly connected to other galleries. Proximity to café and parents’ room is required but not so close to act as a creche for parents using the café.

- Size - 80m2
- Lighting - Track exhibition and track lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Noise control/bleeding. Power and data reticulated through floor boxes to accommodate showcases. Interactive artwork. Power and data points must also accommodate wall mounted and/or ceiling mounted projectors.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard with humidity control.
- Finishes - 4m high ceilings reinforced to support suspension of objects. Walls rated to suitably support artwork. Hard flooring. Reading and activities areas. Book displays. Consideration for playground designer.

Gallery 2

Galleries 2 and 3 should have the ability to open into one space if required.

- Size - 80m2
- Lighting - Track exhibition and house lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Noise control/bleeding. Power and data reticulated through floor boxes to accommodate showcases. Power and data points must also accommodate wall mounted and/or ceiling mounted projectors.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum grade to AICCM standards.
- Finishes - 4m high ceilings reinforced to support suspension of objects. Walls rated to suitably support artwork.

Gallery 3

Galleries 2 and 3 should have the ability to open into one space if required.

- Size - 80m2
- Lighting - Track exhibition and house lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Noise control/bleeding. Power and data reticulated through floor boxes to accommodate showcases. Power and data points must also accommodate wall mounted and/or ceiling mounted projectors.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum grade to AICCM standards.
- Finishes - 4m high ceilings reinforced to support suspension of objects. Walls rated to suitably support artwork. Hard flooring.

Gallery 4 (Temporary Exhibitions)

Gallery 4 will host visiting or temporary exhibits. The room requires proximity to the loading dock due to the more frequent bumping in and out of exhibits. The room should have the flexibility to divide into two or more spaces for smaller exhibits.

- Size - 180m2
- Lighting - Track lighting for exhibition and house lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Noise control/bleeding. Power and data reticulated through floor boxes to accommodate showcases. Power and data points must also accommodate wall mounted and/or ceiling mounted projectors.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum grade to AICCM standards.
- Finishes - 4m high ceilings reinforced to support suspension of objects. Walls rated to suitably support artwork. Consideration of more resilient finishes due to more frequent collection movement. ‘Neutral’ materials and palette: hard floor finish, reinforced plaster walls (for repeated installation and repatching). Single room with moveable walls.

Gallery 5 (Multimedia/Immersive Technology)

The Gallery 5 entry needs to consider light and noise spills. Preference for s-bends (no door). The room will host wall/floor/ceiling displays. Modest furnishing required for quiet reflection or elderly and mobility impaired visitors. The room should be simple and have directional entry and exit to the main area.

- Size - 80m2
- Lighting - Track exhibition and house lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Noise control/bleeding. Power and data reticulated through floor boxes to accommodate showcases.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum grade to AICCM standards.
- Finishes - 4m high ceilings reinforced to support suspension of objects. Walls rated to suitably support artwork. Hard flooring.

Faith Exhibition Gallery

An immersive space showcasing traditional Islamic art forms typically found in prayer spaces and interior design. Conceived as a feature, it will integrate traditional Islamic tiles, arabesque motifs, calligraphy and decorative elements in harmonious composition to create a rich cultural and sensory experience. This space will be the starting point of the visitor journey, guiding guests from an environment of artistic and spiritual immersion through to the museum’s galleries.

Entry to the Faith Exhibition Gallery will be free of charge. For this reason, its location should be carefully considered in relation to nearby amenities to ensure accessibility and visitor convenience. The room may also host informal gatherings, conversations and readings, enhancing its role as a welcoming and versatile cultural space.

- Size - 100m2
- Lighting - Natural lighting to centre of the room via a dome or dome-like ceiling. Track for exhibition and house lighting. Directional floor lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Noise control/bleeding. Provision for projections. Power and data reticulated through floor boxes to accommodate showcases.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard. Collection items to be humidity and temperature controlled from display cabinets.
- Finishes - Ceilings reinforced to support suspension of objects. Walls rated to suitably support artwork. Hard flooring to perimeter, potentially marble. Floor and wall tiling. Calligraphy, decorations and Islamic art displays on periphery.

Foyer & Entry

Overall, the museum must integrate into the natural environment with the foyer and entry, providing a contemporary and grand transitional experience. A welcome desk will provide services to the foyer and gift shop.

The foyer and entry will need to accommodate large school groups as this is a key income for museum. It is expected the entrance will comfortably accommodate up to a maximum of 100 students at a time. It is expected that students should have the same welcoming experience as general visitors. Lockers may provide spaces for bag drops or wheeled trolleys that can be stored below the theatrette seating.

The area adjacent to the foyer must accommodate a staircase to the first floor and house lifts. The ground floor entry and first floor constitute the first stage of the building. It is anticipated that two or three floors will be added later (as funds permit). It is essential to factor these future additions into the design of the foyer, stairwell and lifts.

- Size - 120m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard.
- Electrical and comms - Power and data. POS shared with the gift shop.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard. Collection items to be humidity and temperature controlled from display cabinets.
- Finishes - Service desk with POS shared with foyer.

Function Room

The function room is to facilitate large events, meetings, school groups, public groups and education programs. Entertainment events and dinners will be hosted by the museum. External venue hire for private events, corporate meetings and events will generate income for the museum. This room requires a discreet service area for receiving meals prior to serving as well as a wet area space. Storage areas for chairs and tables are required.

This room should connect to foyer to provide a larger space for major events and functions. It should function separately from and while the museum is operating. Acoustic spillage from one function to another as well as from Parramatta Rd should be considered.

- Size - 120m2, The room should seat 200 people in a dining room setup together with the foyer.
- Lighting - Natural and standard. Track lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Power and data. AV requirements such as projector and screen.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Suitable flooring. Resilient walls.

Gift Shop

The gift shop should operate in proximity to the foyer reception desk to share staff resources. The gift shop traditionally is the last destination for museum visitors. The gift shop will encourage sharing of cultural heritage and increase brand awareness through the sale of unique and affordable keepsakes.

- Size - 50m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard.
- Electrical and comms - Power and data. POS shared with the foyer.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Service desk with POS. Fixed joinery for display areas.

Production Room

The production room will be for digital production with online presence and podcasting.

- Size - 25m2
- Lighting - Standard and track lighting. Fully adjustable lighting to blackout.
- Electrical and comms - Audio and visual for podcasting and online presentations. Power and data. Wi-Fi. USB. Secure entry via swipe or code entry.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Suitable flooring. Soundproof finishes.

Cafe & Kitchen

The café should allow servicing to local visitors outside museum opening hours. The kitchen should allow for servicing functions, in-house events, and lunches to visiting schools and patrons. The café should be directly accessible from the outside for out of hours removal of waste and deliveries.

- 40m2 café, 30m2 kitchen
- Lighting - Natural and standard
- Electrical and comms - Power and data. POS. Suitably equipped kitchen.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard. Suitable kitchen exhaust.
- Finishes - Suitable storage and pantries. Wet and dry store.

Offices 1&2

Two private offices, each measuring 15m2, are required for senior management. These offices should be suitable not only for individual work but also for holding small staff meetings and hosting guests.

- Size - Total 30m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard office lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard
- Finishes - Standard office fit-out.

Theatrette

The theatrette should accommodate up to 100 patrons. Consideration needs to be given to steepness of the seating. Tiered seating should accommodate storage below for bags or resources. The lecture theatrette should be in proximity to the foyer with openable walls.

- Size - 170m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard.
- Electrical and comms - Audio and visual aids from moveable lectern. Power and data. Wi-Fi. USB.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Retractable screen and projector. Fully adjustable lighting to blackout. Suitable flooring. Soundproof finishes.

Offices 3&4

Two offices, each measuring 50m2, are intended to accommodate up to 10 museum staff in an open-plan layout. A dedicated security workspace should be incorporated within each open-plan office to support operational needs.

Both offices should have direct access to the breakout area to facilitate staff comfort, informal collaboration and ease of movement between workspaces.

- Size - Total 100m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard office lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Standard office fit-out.

Wet & Dry Craft Rooms 1&2

The dry and wet craft rooms should be adjacent to each other, with the ability to create a larger combined workspace when required. Both rooms should include adequate storage space for materials and equipment.

Each room should also be designed to accommodate a standard seated educational space layout, enabling them to be used for general teaching as well as craft activities.

- Size - 2 x 40m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard.
- Electrical and comms - Audio and visual aids from moveable lectern. Power and data. Wi-Fi. USB.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Suitable flooring with soundproof finishes. Hard flooring in art rooms.

Meeting Room

A general meeting room is required for staff collaboration and other internal meetings. This space should be flexible so it can also function as an additional educational space when needed.

- Size - 35m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard office lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Standard office fit-out. Glass partitions.

Staff & Student Breakout Area

A breakout area is required for museum staff and students, which will also function as a lunch space. The area should include a small kitchenette equipped to support daily use.

- Size - 40m2
- Lighting - Natural and standard office lighting.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Standard.
- Finishes - Standard office fit-out. Glass partitions.

Loading Dock

The loading dock should be appropriately sized to meet the museum’s collection handling and operational requirements. If possible, a separate delivery area should be provided to service the kitchen and manage general waste, ensuring these functions are kept distinct from collection movements.

- Size - 30m2
- Lighting - Warehouse style.
- Electrical and comms - Single and 3-phase.
- Mechanical ventilation - Nil.
- Finishes - Resilient.

Loading Dock

The loading dock should be sized accordingly to support collection and operational requirements. The dock should have close proximity to the Temporary Gallery. The dock should also include a separate room with storage (refer section 2.1.16) to undertake minor conservation and repair with adequate lighting and mechanical ventilation similar to a gallery conditions. A separate delivery area will be required to service the kitchen and general waste.

- Size – TBA
- Lighting – Warehouse style
- Electrical and Comms – Single and 3-phase
- Mechanical Ventilation – Nil
- Finishes – Resilient

Collection Storage & Conservation

This is a specialised storeroom designed for receiving and preparing artworks for exhibition. The space should also support minor conservation and repair work, requiring adequate task lighting and mechanical ventilation to maintain conditions similar to those of a gallery environment.

- Size - 30m2
- Lighting - Museum standard.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum standard.
- Finishes - Museum standard.

Archive Room

The Archive Room will be a secure, climate-controlled environment for long-term storage and preservation of the museum’s records, documents and other sensitive materials. It should meet professional archival standards to ensure the protection of paper-based and digital assets.

- Size - 50m2
- Lighting - Museum standard.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum standard.
- Finishes - Museum standard.

Storage Rooms

The Archive Room will be a secure, climate-controlled environment for long-term storage and preservation of the museum’s records, documents and other sensitive materials. It should meet professional archival standards to ensure the protection of paper-based and digital assets.

- Size - 50m2
- Lighting - Museum standard.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum standard.
- Finishes - Museum standard.

Amenities

The Archive Room will be a secure, climate-controlled environment for long-term storage and preservation of the museum’s records, documents and other sensitive materials. It should meet professional archival standards to ensure the protection of paper-based and digital assets.

- Size - 50m2
- Lighting - Museum standard.
- Electrical and comms - Wi-Fi. USB. Power and data.
- Mechanical ventilation - Museum standard.
- Finishes - Museum standard.

Plantrooms

Plantrooms are to be suitably sized to accommodate the requirements of proposed plant.

Parking & Traffic

Provision for parking must comply with City of Parramatta requirements. Building car parking access is to be provided via the rear lanes.

Parking and traffic circulation must be able to accommodate two full-sized coach buses for school and group visits. Given that Carlotta and Harmon Lanes are unlikely to accommodate buses, a suitable alternative must be identified. Possible solutions include negotiating with Council for a dedicated bus parking space along the Kemp Street kerb or developing another viable arrangement to safely manage school bus access and parking.

SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

- 6.1 Competition Details
- 6.2 Contact Details
- 6.3 Competition Program Key Dates
- 6.4 Evaluation Criteria
- 6.5 Competition Conditions

Competition Details

ISRA intends to engage the winning architect through the single stage Competition process described below. ISRA will collaborate with the winning Competitor to develop their design.

All documents shall be read in conjunction with the Competition conditions and the technical information provided in the appendices.

The Submission requirements are to include:

- Up to a maximum 12 x A1 panels. This is provided as a guideline only; competitors are free to determine how best to present their design proposals within this limit.
- Statement of response, A3 design report with a maximum 25-pages to include;
 - » Response to how the proposal complies with Council controls;
 - » Response to how the submissions responds to the Museums brief and vision.
- Renders of key spaces;
- Evaluation of ecologically sustainable development principles.
- Materials and information related to how the Competitor intends to deliver the project;
- Key personnel, including qualifications, a brief CV and description of their role for the project.
- Approaches to resourcing;
- Methodology;
- Professional fees for the design development, including design sufficient for lodging the works approval and subsequent construction documentation (refer to Appendix H returnable schedules).
- Schedule of disbursements (refer to Appendix H returnable schedules). Cost estimate prepared by the Architects Quantity Surveyor;
- A high-level elemental cost plan using the AIOS Elemental Classification or equivalent recognised industry standard. The estimate will include all construction costs. Architect to confirm as part of their Submission that their design meets the budget as noted in this document. The project quantity surveyor will peer review cost plans/ estimates prepared by each firm to ensure alignment and completeness. The cost plan must include:
 - » Summary of total estimated cost (excl. GST).
 - » Breakdown by building elements (e.g. substructure, superstructure, finishes, services, external works, preliminaries).
 - » Assumptions and exclusions.
 - » Cost per square metre (GFA and/or NLA as applicable).
 - » All costs must be based on current (Q3 2025) market rates in Sydney, NSW. The estimate should reflect concept-level accuracy and be suitable for comparative assessment only.
- Insurances
- Soft (digital) and hard copies of the Submission

Soft copy submission

Soft copy submissions must be issued to RP Infrastructure and ISRA by 4pm Australia Eastern Standard Time (AEST) on Friday 6th June 2025. Submissions are to be made via a Teams folder link, which will be issued in an addendum.

The soft copy submission must include:

- PDF format images of each A1 presentation board;
- Completed submission forms;
- PDF of design report;
- PDF of the cost plan.

Hard copy submission

Hard copy submission must be marked Confidential and delivered to:

Address: Level 3/128-136 South Parade, Auburn NSW 2144 by 4pm Australia Eastern Standard Time (AEST) on Friday 6th June 2025.

Presentation

All competitors will be required to make a presentation, in person, to the Jury. This presentation should be based on the materials submitted as required by the Competition timetable. Animations or fly throughs are welcome but not considered to be part of the submission requirements. Animations or fly throughs are not required.

Contact Details

The Competition Manager is Russell Kosko, Senior Project Manager RP Infrastructure. Respondents must issue all requests for information via email to Russell Kosko and Salma Malik via the contact details provided.

Competition Program Key Dates

Indicative Key Milestones

Milestones	Target Date
Competition Launched - Brief Issued	August 2025
Question & Answer Period	September 2025
Mid Competition Review & Fee Proposal	October 2025
Submissions Lodged	November 2025
Panel Presentation	December 2025
Submissions Evaluated	February 2026
Competition Winner Announced (publically)	April 2026
Announcement of Final Design	June 2026

Payment

In recognition of their design and time commitment, a contribution of AUD\$20,000.00 will be paid to each Entrant in the competition who submits a compliant entry. This payment will be made following the Submission assessment period.

The contribution will be additional to any agreed professional fees for post-competition services commissioned by ISRA.

Evaluation Criteria

Competitors are to provide a concept design illustrating the broad conceptual approach to the project resolving key planning issues and functional planning relationships, and defining architectural and landscape character, internally and externally.

In assessing submissions, the jury will use the following broad evaluation criteria:

Assessment Criteria	Weighting (%)
Design concept and architectural vision and Cultural and Islamic Design Interpretation	30%
Site Response and Context Integration	20%
Functional and Spatial Planning	20%
Buildability and Cost Feasibility	20%
Sustainability and Environmental Considerations	10%
Compliance with Brief and Regulations	Non-weighted
ISRA Community consultation: community response to the overall design of each submission. Responses are to be collated and shared with the jury. The responses will be non-binding.	Non-weighted

Mid Competition Review

A Mid-Competition Review and Fee Proposal submission are proposed for Friday 16 May 2025. This milestone is a checkpoint for design progress and commercial alignment. The associated architectural fees, should the Competitor be selected, will also be reviewed.

The review will be conducted as a confidential session between each Competitor and the Competition manager as well as technical advisers as necessary. Each Competitor will be invited to present a short overview of their design direction to date and discuss key design or project queries.

The session will be chaired by the Competition Manager. It is not a formal jury presentation and no scoring or elimination will occur at this stage. The purpose is to provide design feedback and allow early dialogue on key issues.

At this stage, Competitors are required to submit an initial fee proposal outlining professional services fees, should they be successful. Fee proposals will be received and held confidentially by the Competition Manager for consideration as part of the broader commercial assessment. It is acknowledged that no decision or negotiation on fees may occur at this time, and the proposals will primarily be used to inform budget planning and future discussions.

Jury Panel Presentation

Competitors will be invited to present their design proposal to the Competition Jury during a formal presentation session. This presentation provides an opportunity to articulate the design intent, respond to jury queries and demonstrate how the proposal aligns with the Competition objectives. Presentations will be followed by a Q&A session and form a key part of the Jury's evaluation process.

Community Consultation

As part of the evaluation process, ISRA will conduct community consultation using the submitted Competition material. This consultation will be web-based and use digital content provided by the Competitors. No in-person or live presentations by Competitors to the community are anticipated as part of the Competition.

Competition Conditions

General

All information contained in this Competition brief is confidential and provided solely for the purpose of the design Competition and may not be used for any other purpose without written permission from ISRA. All information/materials provided by a Competitor in response to this Competition is considered commercial-in-confidence and will be held, considered and disposed of in confidence to the extent required by the law.

Competition Preparation

When issuing their submission, Competitors are required to examine all information provided or referenced as part of the Competition brief. Competitors must examine all information pertaining to risks, contingencies and other circumstances affecting their Submission and satisfy itself that the Submission including price is correct, and it is financially and practically viable for it to enter and perform the proposed Agreement. Competitors will be deemed to have made their own enquiries regarding the scope of services and the requirements and content of this Competition brief prior to lodging their Submission. The information contained in this Competition brief has been provided for the Competitor's guidance and on a best endeavour basis. Unless expressly stated otherwise in this brief, ISRA gives no warranty nor makes any representation as to the currency, reliability or completeness of the information contained in the brief and shall not be held liable for errors or omissions.

Mandatory Briefing and Site Inspection

A mandatory briefing and site inspection will be held by the contact person within one week of the Competition documents being issued. Further information will be issued about the meeting details. The contact person and project team will be available at that time to field Competitors' queries.

Eligibility to Participate in the Competition

Competitors are only eligible if they have been invited to participate by ISRA. ISRA contracts only with recognised and acceptable legal entities. ISRA does not contract with firms under any form of external administration. Submissions can only be offered by organisations that are a legal entity or, if a joint Submission, by legal entities with the capacity to contract. ISRA will only enter an agreement with a legal entity or entities. Any submission submitted by an unincorporated business, such as a sole trader, partnership or business name, must identify the legal entity that proposes to enter the contract. If Competitors from entities are proposing to contract in their capacity as trustees, the evidence required may include copies of the relevant trust deeds. Any evidence requested is to be provided within three business days of the request. ISRA reserves the right to reject any Submission if they judge the Competitor as not having an appropriate financial capability.

Communications

All enquiries to and communications with ISRA in respect of this Competition are to be directed to the Competition Manager (contact person) via email for reasons of probity. Any contact with that person through other means or with other ISRA personnel regarding this Competition may be considered a breach of these terms. Information given to clarify any aspect of this Competition will be given to all Competitors to ensure there will be no unfair advantage. All Requests for Information need to be submitted formally via email to the contact person and responses will be issued to all Competitors.

Technical Advisers

The Jury may be supported by a panel of technical advisers with expertise in areas such as engineering, cost planning, planning and construction. These advisers will provide independent technical assessments of the submissions to inform the Jury's decision-making. They will not have voting rights but may attend deliberations if requested by the Jury and approved by ISRA.

Clarifications and Questions

During the Q&A period, competitors may submit questions or seek clarification regarding the Competition brief or conditions. All queries must be submitted in writing by 4pm on 10 September 2025 via email to Russell.kosko@rpinfrastructure.com and Salma.malik@rpinfrastructure.com.au.

Responses to all questions will be issued to all registered participants via an addendum to ensure equal access to information.

Conformity of Submissions

Competitors are expected to provide Submissions that conform to the terms of the Competition. Non-conforming Submissions may be excluded at ISRA's discretion from the Competition process without further consideration.

The Competitor must indicate its compliance with the terms and conditions of this Competition and the proposed Agreement by completing the necessary declarations and statements within the Returnable Schedules. Failure to do so or not being able to meet ISRA's requirements will negatively impact ISRA's evaluation of a Competitor's suitability and place the Submission in a position of disadvantage.

It is expected that Competitors will supply all information requested. If this is not possible, the Competitor must clearly state the information or material not included in their Submission and the reason for its absence. Additional documents or information provided by a Competitor outside the information requested may not be considered or evaluated by ISRA and may place the Competitor in a position of disadvantage. Any conditions or caveats a Competitor submits relating to its participation in the Competition will not apply unless expressly accepted by ISRA in writing.

Competition Submission

Information provided in the Submission must be in writing and English. Pricing must be in Australian dollars, exclusive of GST. The Returnable Schedules must be completed in accordance with the instructions therein and all supporting

information attached to the schedules and clearly referenced.

Hard and soft copy Submissions are to be presented by the time and date and via the means referred to Section 6.1. Late Submissions will not be considered, except where ISRA is satisfied that the integrity and competitiveness of the Competition process has not been compromised. ISRA shall not penalise any Competitor whose Submission is received late if the delay is due solely to mishandling.

ISRA may, at its discretion, extend the Closing Time.

The soft copy Submission can only be made via the Teams link, which will be issued via an addendum for submission. This will enable each Competitor to upload their files.

It is required that electronic files be kept as small as practical to be submitted via the Teams link. Electronic Submissions will be treated in accordance with the Electronic Transactions Act 2000 (NSW) and given the appropriate level of confidentiality, probity and attention.

By making a Submission, a Competitor is considered to have accepted the terms and conditions of this Competition.

If a Competitor provides multiple Submissions, the latest one received will be evaluated unless the Competitor provides clear direction as to whether the lodgement is an alternative Submission, supporting information or an addition or clarification to the previous Submission.

Partnerships and Subconsultants

Competitors are permitted to partner with other consultants (e.g. landscape architects, specialist subconsultants) during the Competition period. Such partnerships are acceptable provided:

- Subconsultants are engaged under the lead proponent (e.g. subcontracted to the lead design team).

- The Competition documents are shared with potential subconsultants strictly for preparing the Competition Submission.
- Fees for subconsultants are clearly itemised below the line in the Submission, including applicable management fees charged by the lead consultant for coordination of services. It is anticipated, following the Competition, a preferred subconsultants list will be developed in collaboration with the successful proponent and RPI will run the formal procurement process for those services.

Competition Validity Period

Submissions will remain open for acceptance by ISRA for six months (180 days) from the closing time.

Probity

ISRA is committed to ensuring that competition for the provision of services requested under this Competition is fair and open. For Competitors, this means that evaluation of Submissions will be conducted consistently and objectively; each Competitor will have access to the same information about the Competition; information provided in the Competition will be secure and all confidential information treated as such; and all actual, potential or perceived conflicts of interest will be addressed. By making a Submission, each Competitor acknowledges that its Submission and negotiations resulting from it will be governed by ISRA's probity requirements. Each Competitor must comply with ISRA probity requirements with respect to all matters arising from their Submission and their participation in the Competition process.

Corruption or Unethical Conduct

Competitors must comply with all applicable NSW and Commonwealth laws, including the Competition and Consumer Act 2010 (Cwlth) and the Fair-Trading Act 1987 (NSW). Competitors must state in their response any circumstances, arrangements, understandings or relationships which constitute or may reasonably be considered to constitute an actual or potential conflict of interest with the Competitor's obligations under this Competition or under an agreement.

Competitors must not communicate with any other Competitor or party in relation to its Submission or engage in collusion or price inflation to compensate unsuccessful Submissions, hidden commissions, anti-competitive conduct or other such arrangements. Evidence of collusive or anti-competitive conduct may result in cancellation of this Competition. Competitors involved in such practices may also be barred from participating in any competitions or tendering for ISRA in future.

If a Competitor or any of its employees is found to have been involved in any of the following, this may result in the Competitor not receiving further consideration: offering inducement or reward to any employee, agent or subcontractor of the Project Team or any ISRA employee, officer or contractor in connection with this Competition or the Submission; engaging in corrupt conduct within the meaning of the Independent Commission Against Corruption Act 1988; having a record or alleged record of unethical behaviour; or being involved in collusive tendering activity or anti-competitive conduct. If ISRA becomes aware of improper conduct by a successful Competitor after an agreement has been executed, it reserves the right to terminate the agreement.

Competition Addenda

During the Competition period, addenda may be issued, which will become part of the Competition.

The Competitor must verify if addenda were issued prior to the closing date, even if they have already submitted. Written addenda issued by ISRA or the Competition representative are the only recognised explanations of, or amendments to, the Competition documents. Addenda will be issued via email to all Competitors within the RPI Teams SharePoint for download.

Competition Costs and Ownership

The Competitor acknowledges that ISRA will make a payment of AUD 20,000 to all eligible Competitors and will not be liable for expenses, costs or losses incurred as a result of its

participation in this Competition, including where the Competition has been discontinued. ISRA may retain all Submissions submitted in response to this Competition to enable it to evaluate proposals and comply with obligations relating to accountability and recordkeeping.

All Submissions become ISRA's property on submission. ISRA may make copies of Submissions for any purpose related to this Competition.

Discontinuance of Competition

The release of this Competition, preparation and delivery of a Submission, and subsequent receipt and evaluation of a Submission do not commit ISRA to award or execute an agreement with any Competitor, even if the Competition requirements are met. ISRA may at its discretion elect to terminate this Competition at any stage and reissue the Competition to market.

Protection of Privacy

The Competitor warrants, in respect of personal information provided in this Competition or contract arising from this Competition, that the information is accurate, up to date and complete, and nominated individuals authorise its collection and are aware that the information is being collected for the purpose of evaluating submissions and administering any contracts arising from those submissions; whether the supply of the information by the individual is required by law or is voluntary, and any consequences for the individual if the information (or any part of it) is not provided; and of the existence of any right of access to, and correction of, the information.

APPENDICES

- 7.1 Appendix A - WestInvest Funding Deed
- 7.2 Appendix B - MIAA Program
- 7.3 Appendix C - SITE Photographs
- 7.4 Appendix D - MIAA Branding Pack
- 7.5 Appendix E - MIAA Gallery Content
- 7.6 Appendix F - Islamic Principles
- 7.7 Appendix G - Pedagogical Brief
- 7.8 Appendix H - Returnable Schedules
- 7.9 Appendix I - Architectural Scope of Services

Photo by Ayrton Tangon Unsplash

Appendices

Appendix A – WestInvest Funding Deed

Appendix B – MIAA Program

Appendix C – Site Photographs

Appendix D – MIAA Branding Pack

Appendix E – MIAA Gallery Content (Indicative only)

Appendix F – Islamic Principles

Appendix G – Pedagogical Brief

Appendix H – Returnable Schedules

Appendix I – Architectural Scope of Services

All Printed Copies are Uncontrolled

Title - Museum of Islamic Art Design Competition

Level 9, 20 Bond Street
Sydney NSW 2000
T +61 2 8272 9300

Level 7, 550 Bourke Street
Melbourne VIC 3000
T +61 3 9653 0600

Level 25, 179 Turbot Street
Brisbane QLD 4000
T +61 2 8272 9300

Suite 6, 52 Macalister Street,
Mackay, QLD 4740
T +61 7 4944 0555

Suite 1, 57 Mitchell Street,
North Ward, QLD 4810
T +61 7 4727 0843

E info@rpinfrastructure.com.au

RP Infrastructure Pty Ltd
ABN 62 065 072 193

rpinfrastructure.com.au